

OARS AND OARSMEN



▲ THRANITES' BENCHES

The rowers on the topmost tier, the thranites, had the toughest job, because of the angle at which their oars entered the water. Consequently, they commanded higher wages than the other rowers.



▲ SEATS FOR OARSMEN

The rowers' conditions were cramped. Each seat was level with the shoulders of the oarsman on the tier below.



▲ FOOT STRETCHER

The crew of the *Olympias* experimented with various rowing techniques, including securing one foot to the stretcher.



▲ TIERS OF OARS

The tiers were staggered to prevent oars from clashing. The lowest oars had leather sheaths to keep water out of the hull.



STEERING THE BOAT



▲ VIEW FROM THE STERN

The helmsman, who steered using a pair of tillers, overlooked the central slot between the decks, where the mast was stowed when not in use.



▲ TILLER

A single helmsman normally controlled both tillers, but if more force was required a man was assigned to each one.



▲ STEERING OAR

Operated by the tillers, the pair of steering oars (rudders) could also be used as brakes to slow the ship's forward movement.